

Adviser Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Document Reference: CAW-SOP-ADV-2026-01

System: Case Ace v2.0 Client Consultation Recording & Note Drafting System

Organisation: Citizens Advice Wandsworth (CAW)

Target Audience: Qualified Generalist Advisers, Caseworkers, and Volunteer Trainees

Effective Date: 2026-09-02

Status: Formally Approved Operating Procedure

Classification: Internal / Operational

1. Introduction and Core Adviser Responsibilities

Case Ace v2.0 is an assistive, privacy-preserving consultation recording and case note drafting application. It is designed to assist you in producing comprehensive, structured consultation notes that meet the Advice Quality Standard (AQS Level 3) while allowing you to maintain full eye contact and active listening with your client.

[!IMPORTANT]

Fundamental Professional Principle:

Case Ace is an assistive drafting tool, not an automated decision-maker.

As the qualified adviser, you retain sole legal, ethical, and professional responsibility for every word, figure, and advice summary pasted into Casebook CRM. You must personally review, verify, and sign off every case note.

2. Step-by-Step Consultation Workflow

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flowchart TD
    A["1. Intake & Consent Gate (Plain English / Easy-Read / Webex)"] --> B["2. Audio Capture (In-Person / Webex / File Import)"]
    B --> C["3. Consultation Concludes & Local Transcription Occurs"]
    C --> D["4. Phase 9 Review Gate: Check Highlighted Identifiers"]
    D --> E["5. Verified Redaction & AI Note Drafting (London Cloud)"]
    E --> F["6. Phase 14 Sign-off Gate: Verify Gaps & Deadlines"]
    F --> G["7. Copy Note to Casebook CRM"]
    G --> H["8. End Session & destroySession() Executes Automatically"]
  
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Step 1: Intake & Obtaining Client Consent

Introduce the tool using the approved Client Consent Script (see docs/operational/client-consent-scripts.md).

Explain clearly:

Recording is voluntary. Choosing not to record has zero impact on their advice or appointment.

Names, dates of birth, and addresses are automatically muted on the computer before note generation.

The recording is deleted immediately once the note is written.

If the client agrees, select the corresponding intake route in the UI and click “Confirm Client Consent & Start Session”.

Step 2: Ingestion Across the Three Intake Routes

Route A: Live In-Person Consultation

Position the bureau microphone equidistant between you and the client.

Click “Start In-Person Recording” in Case Ace.

Conduct the advice interview normally.

If the client asks to pause or stop, click “Pause Recording” or “Withdraw Consent” immediately.

Route B: Cisco Webex Telephony Consultation

Answer or initiate the call in your Cisco Webex softphone application.

Inform the telephone client using the Telephone Webex Consent Script.

In Case Ace, click “Connect Webex Call Stream”. The application binds to the active Webex call and begins in-memory streaming.

When the call ends, Case Ace automatically detects call hangup and begins transcription.

Route C: Importing Externally Captured Recordings (Home Visits / Outreach)

(See Section 3 below for full mandatory protocol).

Step 3: Phase 9 Identifier Review Gate

Once local transcription finishes (typically within 10–20 seconds):

The Phase 9 Review Gate appears on your screen displaying the draft transcript with detected personal identifiers highlighted in green (names, NINOs, addresses, phone numbers, health terms).

Scan the transcript:

If an identifier was missed (e.g. an unusual nickname or foreign reference number), highlight the word with your cursor and click “Redact As Identifier”.

If a non-identifying word was mistakenly tagged, click it and select “Remove Redaction”.

Click “Approve Redactions & Generate Note”.

Case Ace immediately performs an acoustic verification pass, mutes the audio stream across those timestamps, and generates the structured draft note.

Step 4: Phase 14 Review, Gap Acknowledgment & Professional Sign-Off

When the draft note appears:

Examine Structure: Verify that the note contains:

Confirmation of Enquiry (Client circumstances and reasons for seeking advice).

Advice Given (Options explained, statutory rights, and benefit calculations).

Agreed Action Plan (Itemized tasks with explicit deadlines for both client and bureau).

Acknowledge Information Gaps:

If the client did not state essential information (e.g. tenancy start date, exact arrears figure, or award end date), Case Ace highlights these as Unverified Gaps.

You must review and check off each gap individually to confirm whether you have verified it offline or whether it remains an outstanding action item.

Interactive Highlighting: Click any sentence in the draft note to instantly inspect the corresponding transcript passage and replay the underlying audio snippet.

Affirmative Sign-Off:

Check the affirmation box: “I confirm that I have personally verified this advice note and take full professional responsibility for its accuracy.”

Click “Copy Signed Note to Clipboard”.

Step 5: Transfer to Casebook & Session Destruction

Switch to your open Casebook CRM window.

Paste the signed note (Ctrl+V or Cmd+V) into the appropriate Case Activity record and save the case.

Return to Case Ace and click “End Session & Wipe Data”.

Case Ace runs destroySession(), zeroing all audio buffers in RAM, clearing transcripts, terminating background workers, and clearing the clipboard.

3. Mandatory Protocol: Importing Externally Captured Recordings

[!CAUTION]

Source File Retention & Disposal Rules:

When recording outreach, home visits, or prison advice sessions using standalone hardware (e.g. Olympus/Sony dictaphones or CAW-managed smartphones), you are responsible for the physical custody and immediate deletion of the source audio file.

EXTERNAL IMPORT LIFECYCLE & DELETION TIMELINE		
Action	Storage Medium	Permitted Retention Period
1. Record consultation in field	Hardware Dictaphone/SD	Max 24 hours (Transit to desk)
2. Connect device to CAW managed laptop	USB Cable	Transient mount

3. Import file into Case Ace UI	Browser Volatile RAM	In-memory processing	
4. Video track discarded (if MP4/MOV)	Memory Buffer	Instant purge	
5. Note signed off & saved to Casebook	Casebook CRM	6 Years (Casework Record)	
6. Delete file from Dictaphone & Laptop	Disk / SD Card	**IMMEDIATE (Within 5 Mins)**	
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Step-by-Step Import & Deletion Procedure:

Connect Device: Plug the approved dictaphone into your CAW-managed laptop.

Select Import File: In Case Ace, select “Import External Recording” and choose the audio/video file (.wav, .mp3, .m4a, .aac, .mp4).

Verify Video Track Discard: If you upload a video file, Case Ace automatically strips and discards the video track, retaining solely the mono audio channel in RAM.

Process Note: Complete the Phase 9 Redaction Gate, review the draft note, and paste it into Casebook CRM.

Immediate Mandatory Physical Deletion:

Open File Explorer / Finder on your laptop.

Delete the source recording file from your dictaphone / SD card.

If the file was copied to your laptop Downloads/ or Temp/ folder, delete it immediately using Permanent Delete (Shift+Delete on Windows / Option+Cmd+Delete on Mac) and empty your Recycle Bin / Trash.

Unplug the dictaphone.

Audit Affirmation: When ending the session in Case Ace, check the box: “I confirm that all local source audio files have been permanently deleted from this computer and external media.”